like finding a path in the water, behind the wave

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/52608604.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
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Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Post-Canon, Canon Compliant, Mild Blood, Hurt/Comfort, Established Relationship, Kissing, Self-Harm, Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Useless Lesbians, Idiots in Love, Everything is Beautiful and Everything Hurts, Self-Worth Issues, Character Development, I Don't Even Know, I Tried, How Do I Tag, Self-Indulgent, I Wrote This Instead of Sleeping, Help, Tags Are Hard, Fluff and Angst, My First Fanfic

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by safefall

Summary

Some days are happier than others.

On the good days, it isn't hard at all for Catra to look at Adora, steal kisses down her neck right as she puts up her hair. It isn't hard for her to jump into She-Ra's arms no matter who is around and let her play with her hair, fingers petting her on the head, pressing into her heart. On the bad days, Catra frightens herself so much that she wakes up after barely even going to sleep with soundless cries stuck to the nose, at her temple, explosives in her eyes. And, every time, Adora wakes too.

-

In which Catra finds out how much Adora truly loves her. Or, a crisis held together only by Adora's inability to let Catra go.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

On a bedding fluffy with pillows in mauve and glittery embroideries that change shape, Adora and Catra are sleeping piled close. Although the sun outside wouldn't exactly cease now in its intensity, the room they are in is always rather dark, Catra loves it that way, of course, but there isn't only that. After the war, all their late evenings were to be spent here, in this soft darkness that remains without reflective diamonds stringed to the ceiling or windows everywhere. Without the Horde's radiations or Prime's fabricated green.

Some days are happier than others.

On the good days, it isn't hard at all for Catra to look at Adora, steal kisses down her neck right as she puts up her hair. It isn't hard for her to jump into She-Ra's arms no matter who is around and let her play with her hair, fingers petting her on the head, pressing into her heart. On the bad days, Catra frightens herself so much that she wakes up after barely even going to sleep with soundless cries stuck to the nose, at her temple, explosives in her eyes. And, every time, Adora wakes too.

It wasn't long until Adora understood the terrors aren't going away without a fight. But if she isn't going to win this fight – what will?

Catra's breathing isn't torturous today and it's a relief. *So nice*, Adora thinks over and over again, ever so slightly stirring awake, all moving limbs, but forever being mindful of Catra as she does. She's hugging her squarely. Catra is half resting on her chest. It feels *so nice* to hold her in their quiet, newfound peace. But.

But Catra screams. Peace breaks wide. Adora's up, shaking Catra by the shoulders firmly, but other than Catra's brows furrowing, and biting teeth, she gets nothing. Tears big enough to hurt leave Adora's eyes, carving wetness onto her cheeks. To really see Catra snap, rise from the bed so fast she's on the floor with an awful thump, hands covering her face, ears, hitting, red wounds

blooming – to hear how she chokes on apologies – "Sorry, so sorry, I'm sorry! Don't look! Just – ah – stay away!" – it – it –

"Catra, no!" She pleads. "Please, stop! *Let* me" with that, Adora flies out of the bed and a couple of nearby pillows follow, "*help* you." She gathers Catra in her arms, Catra who's straining, thrashing, and trying her best to push back. If not for Catra opening her eyes in shock or her stilling, Adora wouldn't have noticed the slices on her own forearms. Catra's grip on them goes slack. She brings one hand to her mouth, the other lingers over Adora's left arm. A bit of fresh blood spills there in a line. Catra can't help but stare at what she's done.

"*Oh*. It's okay! I – see?" Adora, in an attempt to rub off the bleeding as quickly as she can, smears it instead. *Stupidstupidstupid*, she thinks.

"Please…" Catra says, so small. She moves back a few inches, arms closing on her sides protectively. But then claws already start digging back into the crimson fabric of her clothes.

"Hey, Catra?" Adora's knees make a shfff sound as she moves to sit in Catra's space again.

"*Catra*…" Clear like a hum, if a little broken, Adora traces her fingers soothingly on the floor next to Catra, whispers her name. At least Catra's not sobbing anymore. Her lips are pressed together, no words come out yet. But.

But slowly she still takes Adora's sweaty palms in her trembling ones and kisses them each. Adora sniffs. And smiles. It makes Catra weak, bold, weak.

"I'm – *sorry*," She begins. Adora sighs, lets her. "I didn't. I. I wasn't. Please, what if I do it again?" Catra's question hits heavy like stone. "L-lock me, *to be sure*, just… lock – " Blue and yellow eyes circle the room once, twice. Thri –

"I'm not. Going to." Adora stutters, clenching and unclenching her jaw. "Come here."

Hesitant, Catra does. It doesn't take long. But it feels like it does.

"How could I? I said it's okay." Adora's vision blurs. Maybe she's just closing her eyes. She can't tell.

"Adora? How is this okay?" The smell of blood drying, the winces, the hurt, everything, the fighting, they were like this. Not okay. Very much not –

"You will grow out of this pain. I know you can, Catra." It sounds quite wrong, doesn't it, like a soldier telling another soldier to move on or else, but underneath it's more like *I got you, I'm not going anywhere*.

It's silent for a while. Silence can be kind, right? Is this kind?

"I can't stop hurting you!" Catra cries out, cornered. "All I do is be the same. Same as in my nightmares… *me*, like the *old* me and I don't want you to hate me. One day you will! You will really come to hate me."

"Ridiculous."

"What?"

"I forgive you." Those lips, they…

"*Adora*."

Those lips, they aren't a lie. But.

"Why?" Catra's blank expression is unreadable.

Why? A hand goes to Catra's chin, it's delicate and warm, a bit bloody. Warm.

"Because I love you. I love this you, that you… Catra, *every* you."

"*Idiot*," Fond. Bloody. True. Catra cups the hand on her chin and leans into the touch. Adora freezes. "I know." That's it. She's taking Catra, pillows and all. Catra's carried to bed *laughing*. That

earns her a sloppy kiss on the forehead. Fine, as well as a sloppy kiss on the lips.

“Okay… um. I can turn into She-Ra, fix us up.” She mindlessly grabs for the sword.

“No.” Catra pushes it away with one leg.

“No?”

“Hm. *Heal*… Like – like this then.” Stretched out on the bed, she motions for Adora to join her. Adora dutifully does. Oh, it takes a week for the messed up skin to scar.

It’s sudden at the same time.

End Notes

thank u so much for reading!! honestly, i'm not sure what comes next. posting for the first time is really, really scary. i'm 100% humbled by this experience. catradora made the jump easier tho. i hope u enjoyed!! <3

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!